

Know what you are trying to hold

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A defender needs a concrete drawing method, not merely stubborn waiting. Possible resources include blockade, checking from a distance, reaching a promotion corner, or creating stalemate. Choose the method that fits the exact material and structure.

WORKED EXAMPLE

In one ending the king must run toward a rook-pawn corner; in another it must stay active to stop a central passer. Following a generic 'keep the king central' rule can miss the only saving route.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How should you study a defensive ending after a loss?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Find the last position with a clear drawing method, identify the move that abandoned it, and practice both sides from that point. Learn the mechanism and its limits.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A draw is often built around one precise defensive resource.